Nico's response to email #1 recieved on 19.April.2024

Hello Ms. Persons,
I am writing to inform you of several negative comments that were said to me, along with offensive statements/behavior that was made by Ms. Bone. In addition, as someone who identifies as a transgender male, Ms. Bone's statements towards me have been discriminatory, humiliating, and as an LAUSD employee, my rights have been violated.

Here are a few examples of the hostile work environment that I have experienced.

Duties assigned to me by Ms. Bone that are in violation of my contract:

- Ms. Bone continuously demands that I come to the school earlier than my contracted start time, although my agreed-upon schedule with Ms. Persons is 8:00 AM. This has occurred on a weekly basis.

- Ms. Bone continuously requests that I create, post, and manage multiple social media accounts on behalf of Hillcrest Drive Elementary School without the clearance and approval of Ms. Persons.

- Ms. Bone continuously requests that I attend and assist her in extracurricular music events outside of my designated work schedule and agreed upon work hours.

Ways in which I've experienced unfavorable working conditions as Ms. Bone's TA:

- When asking Ms. Bone for clarification, she responds by creating a hostile environment, raises her voice at me, angrily slams her hands on her desk, and verbally reprimands me both in private and in the presence of students and employees. This took place on Monday, April 15, 2024, but tends to occur regularly. Her adverse reactions have triggered me to have panic attacks, leaving me to feel overwhelmed and unsafe in her presence.

- On Monday, April 15, 2024, Ms. Bone physically violated me by repeatedly slapping my wrist while frantically scolding me to complete a task in front of Ms. TT, while she was sharing information with me about a field trip that I am participating in.

- When I felt myself becoming overwhelmed as I was sitting through one of her rants, I politely asked her to give me a moment to gather myself. She responded by telling me that I needed to take the rest of the day off. She expressed this by saying, "You need to go out on the yard and find your Momma. You can't be here. Leave because I have no interest in hearing anything from your mouth. You don't have to be here, since this is my classroom." This occurred on Monday, April 15, 2024.

- During a class session about a week ago (sometime between 4/8/2024-4/12/2024), Ms. Bone told one of the 4th graders that she found one of the girls "sexy" while they were in instruction for a



piano piece. The student felt uncomfortable, and I suggested that she take that statement back, in which she responded, "I'm sorry I forgot you're too sensitive for that."

- During breaks in between upcoming classes, she has casually made barrages of deranged and harsh remarks regarding her feeling frustrated with the day's flow, as well as from teachers and students. It goes along the lines of disrespecting, bullying, and slandering children while they are not currently present in the classroom. I recall one time when she stated to me in a joking manner that she, "feels like taking an AR-15 and letting it rip" on the students". She has also poked fun at and put down certain students who may have speech impediments, certain health conditions, and/or learning disabilities. I do not have a specific date for this occurring, since comments like these come in many occasions, but they have definitely tainted the learning environment and has caused me great anxiety, embarrassment, and depressive symptoms while having to work with her.

- On Thursday, April 11, 2024, I came back to the classroom from a bathroom break. Upon entering the classroom, she made a derogatory remark about my body. She said, "Sir, I need you to wear a layered undershirt, because I can see your titties. Your chest is fine, but your nipples aren't." On that day, I was wearing a black t-shirt where I was fully clothed, and none of my anatomy was exposed. Upon being assigned as Ms. Bone's TA, I confided in her, as well as some other colleagues, that I am a transgender man because I wanted to make sure that I was in a protected space. Her violation of this makes me feel deeply uncomfortable, objectified, and as though she intentionally attacked me and my gender identity.

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